FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-31-22004

Issue Title : New 737 MAX Digital Flight Data Recorder (DFDR) Mandatory Data Frame: 737-8A

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3131-11	-7, -8, -8200, -9
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
11/11/2022	10/15/2023	05/15/2023
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	

Revision Description

Revised Status section to inlude exempted Line Numbers.

Changed Milstone Production Incorporation from Target to Complete

Update Service Bulletin Release date and reference to SB-737-31-2114

Description

This Fleet Team Digest (FTD) article provides information on the new 737 MAX Digital Flight Data Recorder (DFDR) Data Frame: 737-8A, which is being updated due to the following:

- European Union Safety Agency (EASA) – AMC1.2 CAT.IDE.A.190 from ED Decision 2021/005/R, which requires compliance to parameters within Table II-A.1 of ED-112A Minimum Operational Performance Specification for Crash Protected Airborne Recorder Systems
- Full Range of Exhaust Gas Temperature (EGT) Parameters described in 737MAX-FTD-31-19007
- Enhanced Angles of Attack Parameters
- Maneuvering Characteristics Augmentation System (MCAS) Engaged bits
- All changes are listed in change notes of Revision G of D226A101-6, Digital Flight Data Acquisition Unit 737 Max Data Frame Interface Control and Requirements Document

The full 737-8A mandatory data frame is defined in Appendix D of D226A101-6 Rev G, which can be obtained on MyBoeingFleet by selecting the Data & Catalog Services and on the left side of the page, entering the document number and pressing Search.

This data frame change will impact DAR/ADR-QAR data in addition to DFDR data. In baseline DAR/ADR-QAR data, odd numbered words are copied from the mandatory data frame and even numbered words are from the DAR AMI application. The baseline DAR

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data frame records at 2048 wps and copies over the entire mandatory frame in alternating words mixed in with the added DAR words. For operators that utilize the DAR AMI application, two airplanes with the same DAR AMI installed will have different recordings if different mandatory DBs are installed. This should be handled by any ground system decoding the data. Operators should ensure that their ground tools can handle this, so that DAR/ADR-QAR data sent from airplanes installed with 737-8 or 737-8A mandatory data frames are decoded properly. The “MANDATORY S/W P/N CODE” parameter (DFDR word 1005/subf 4/supf 2) will identify which mandatory data frame is installed. See Note 2F of D226A101-6 for more information on this coding.

Status

In October 2022, the D226A101-6 document was updated to add the new data frame layout and included a table of changes from 737-8 to the 737-8A data frame.

In November 2022, the new DFDR data frame, 737-8A, will be installed on airplane deliveries starting with LN 8496, with the exemption of the following LNs: 8496, 8499, 8502, 8504, 8507, 8510,8514,8517, 8519, 8521, 8524, 8528, 8531, 8534, 8537, 8540, 8543, 8546, 8549, 8552, 8555, 8559, 8562, 8566, 8570, 8575, 8578, 8581, 8584, 8588, 8591, 8597, 8601, 8605, 8609, 8612, 8616, 8619, 8622, 8625, 8630, 8635, 8639, 8643, 8647, 8652, 8656, 9661, 8664, 8667, 8672.

Mandatory Software for the 737-8A data frame is installed on the DFDAU as 31 DFDAU MANDATORY DB P/N: BCG41-3131-5705. This replaces the existing 31 DFDAU MANDATORY DB P/N: TDY44-7095-2501 which has the 737-8 data frame.

Service Bulletin SB-737-31-2114 is available for customers that would like to update in-service airplanes from the 737-8 mandatory data frame to the to 737-8A.

Interim Action

Boeing recommends operators ensure that their ground tools can handle decoding the:

1) New 737-8A DFDR mandatory data frame data

2) DAR/ADR-QAR data with the new 737-8A DFDR mandatory data frame installed.

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Final Action

Boeing to provide a Service Bulletin for operators to upgrade to the 737-8A if operators wish to maintain commonality in their 737 MAX fleet.

New DFDR data frame, 737-8A, will be installed as 31 DFDAU MANDATORY DB P/N: BCG41-3131-5705 on deliveries starting with LN 8496 (November 2022).

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

IC&RD Revision G: October 12, 2022 (Complete)
Production Incorporation on LN 8496: November 2022 (Complete)

Service Letter Available: TBD
Service Bulletin Released: April 26, 2023 (Complete)
Parts Available: TBD

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Service Bulletin (SB)	SB-737-31-2114		
Other	D226A101-6	Rev G	
Fleet Team Digest Article (FTD)	737MAX-FTD-31-19007		
Airplane Configuration Bulletin (ACB)	2022-ACB-0019-1		

Related Categories

- Airplane Maintenance Issues : Issues that occur during airplane maintenance or have an impact on airplane reliability
- New Equipment : Information on new parts available now or soon to be introduced

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